PROVIDED TO YOU BY YOUR LISTING AGENT

[Listing Agent Name]

[Brokerage Name] · [License #]

[Agent Phone] · [Agent Email]

NEXA Lending

James Barnes
Senior Loan Officer · NEXA Lending · NMLS 215987
(512) 228-8124 · jbarnes@nexalending.com



FOR HOMEOWNERS WHO ARE SELLING AND MOVING

Know Before You Go

Find out what you can qualify for **before** you list, before you pack, and before you sign anything. It takes about five minutes and it's free.

The interactive tools (prequalification check and area comparison) work on the live page: **https://jbarnes1960.github.io/know-before-you-go/**. Worksheets below can be filled in by hand.

WHY NOW

Don't list first and find out later

Selling your home is the easy part. The surprise usually comes when it's time to buy the next one. Many sellers list, get an offer, and only then learn they can't get the new mortgage they assumed they could. Then the move is on a clock and the options are thin.

Credit issues
A late payment, a high card balance, or an old collection can change which loan programs you can use and what they cost. Some of it can be fixed, but it takes time you won't have once you're under contract.

Income changes
A new job, less overtime, retirement, or going self-employed changes how a lender counts your income. Better to hear that now than during underwriting.

Higher costs in the new area
Property taxes, insurance, HOA dues, and flood or wind coverage can be very different from where you live today, and they all count toward your qualifying payment.

What checking first gives you

- **A real price range** for your next home, so you shop and list with confidence.
- **Time to fix things** (pay down a card, correct a credit report error, document income) before they become deadlines.
- **Better timing choices**, such as whether to sell first, buy first, or ask for a longer closing or a rent-back.
- **No rushed decisions** and fewer deals falling apart late.

Checking with a loan officer does not commit you to anything. Your listing agent and I work together so your sale and your purchase fit.

TOOL 1

Quick prequalification check

Enter your numbers and see your debt-to-income ratios and the loan programs you would *likely* fit. Everything is calculated in your browser. Nothing is sent until you press "Send my results to James."

Gross monthly income (before taxes) all borrowers, $

Credit score range your best estimate

Choose…

Monthly debts that show on your credit report (do not include your current housing payment if it will be paid off at closing)

Car payments

Student loans

Credit card minimums

Other debts (child support, personal loans…)

The home you're moving to

Target purchase price, $

Down payment available, $ (e.g. from your sale)

Where (city, state)

Your estimated monthly housing payment is needed to figure the ratios. Either type the total, or let the tool add it up from the pieces. **I don't supply a rate:** use one from a quote or a loan estimate, and the comparison tool below can feed in taxes and insurance.

Option A: total new monthly housing payment, $
(principal, interest, taxes, insurance, HOA)

Or use Option B below. If you fill Option A, it's used.

Option B: interest rate % from a quote

Term

30 years

Property tax rate % per year

Home insurance, $ per year

HOA, $ per month

Mortgage insurance, $ per month (if quoted)

A few things that change the answer

- [ ] I or my spouse served in the military (VA loan may be possible)
- [ ] Late payments or collections in the last 12 months
- [ ] Bankruptcy, foreclosure, or short sale in the last 7 years
- [ ] My income changed, or will change, in the last 2 years (new job, self-employed, retiring, less overtime)
- [ ] The new home is in a rural area

Show my ratios and likely programs

TOOL 2

Where you live now vs. where you're going

On the live page (jbarnes1960.github.io/know-before-you-go), type your current city and your new city to see a side-by-side comparison of home values, rent, household income, property taxes, state income tax, sales tax, and cost of living for about 6,700 U.S. cities and towns, using U.S. Census Bureau, BEA, and Tax Foundation data. Or fill in this worksheet by hand:

	Now	Moving to	Difference
City, state			
Typical home value			
Typical rent			
Property tax rate / yearly tax			
State income tax			
Sales tax			
Cost of living (US = 100)			
Home insurance, HOA, utilities			

Your notes (schools, commute, insurance quotes, anything else you want to remember)

Sources: Home value, rent, household income, population, and property taxes paid: U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey 2020–2024 5-year estimates (tables B25077, B25064, B19013, B01003, B25103), medians for each city or town of about 5,000+ people. Effective property tax rate = median real estate taxes paid ÷ median home value, a rough estimate; your actual bill depends on the appraisal, local rates, and exemptions. Cost of living: U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis, Regional Price Parities 2024 (released Feb. 2026), by metro area; towns outside a metro area use their state's non-metro figure. State income tax: Tax Foundation, top marginal rate on wages as of Jan. 1, 2026 (local income taxes not included). Sales tax: Tax Foundation, state plus average local rate as of July 1, 2026 (state-wide average; the rate in a given city may differ). "n/a" means the source has no figure for that place.

CHECKLIST 1

What a lender will ask for

Start collecting these now. Requirements vary by loan program, and your loan officer may ask for more.

- [ ] Photo ID and Social Security number
- [ ] Last 30 days of pay stubs
- [ ] W-2s for the last 2 years
- [ ] Federal tax returns for the last 2 years (all pages)
- [ ] Self-employed: year-to-date profit and loss, business returns if applicable
- [ ] Last 2 months of bank statements (all pages, all accounts)
- [ ] Retirement and investment account statements
- [ ] Explanation letters for large deposits, gaps in employment, or credit issues
- [ ] Gift letter and donor statements, if family is helping
- [ ] Divorce decree or child support documents, if they apply
- [ ] Veterans: Certificate of Eligibility (James can request it)
- [ ] Signed listing agreement and your sale contract (shows cash from your sale)
- [ ] Current mortgage statement (payoff estimate)
- [ ] Homeowners insurance quote for the new home

CHECKLIST 2

Moving checklist

Before you list

- [ ] Run the prequalification check above and talk to James
- [ ] Pull your credit reports (annualcreditreport.com) and fix errors
- [ ] Get a net sheet from your listing agent
- [ ] Decide your timing: sell first, buy first, or a rent-back
- [ ] Declutter, repair, and schedule photos

While under contract

- [ ] Keep jobs, cards, and bank accounts steady. No new debt.
- [ ] Send lender documents the same day they're requested
- [ ] Book movers and get quotes
- [ ] Set up insurance for the new home

Final 2 weeks

- [ ] Change your address (USPS, banks, DMV, subscriptions)
- [ ] Transfer or schedule utilities at both homes
- [ ] Update school and medical records
- [ ] Pack an essentials box and keep key papers with you
- [ ] Plan for your closing funds (cashier's check or wire, verified by phone)

Move day

- [ ] Final walkthrough at the new home
- [ ] Photograph meters, and hand over all keys and openers
- [ ] Confirm your closing time with the title company

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